Nicolas Polasek

PhD Student · Agricultural and Resource Economics

University of California, Berkeley,
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Education

University of California, Berkley — *Berkeley, CA*
PhD Agricultural and Resource Economics — *August 2021 - May 2027 (exp.)*
- Advisors: Jeremy Magruder, Marco Gonzalez-Navarro, Edward Miguel

University of Geneva — *Geneva, Switzerland*
MSc Economics — *September 2017 - June 2019*
- Advisor: Giacomo De Giorgi

University of Geneva — *Geneva, Switzerland*
BA International Relations — *September 2012 - June 2016*

Research

Working Papers

"Market Integration and the Absorption of Displacement" [Job Market Paper - Draft coming soon]

Work in Progress

"The Social Penalty of Underemployment" with Eric Ochieng and Frederick Aila [Funding secured]

"The Effect of Cash Transfers and Village Savings Groups on Youth in Rural Settings: Evidence from the DRC" with Jeremy Magruder and Eleanor Wiseman [Experiment finalized]

"Natural Disasters and Social Policy: Evidence from Goma's youths" with Jeremy Magruder and Eleanor Wiseman [Experiment finalized]

"How does Agricultural Mechanization affect Labor Markets in Sub-Saharan Africa: the Case of Tractor Services in Nigeria"

Teaching Experience

Fall 2025 **Applied Statistics 1 (COMPSS 212)**, Graduate Student Instructor
Fall 2024 **Introductory Applied Econometrics (EEP 118)**, Graduate Student Instructor
Fall 2022 **Development Economics (EEP C151)**, Graduate Student Instructor

Research Assistance

2025 **Spring and Fall Semesters: Graduate Student Researcher**, for Prof. Jeremy Magruder, UC Berkeley
2024 **Spring: Graduate Student Researcher**, for Prof. Jeremy Magruder and Prof. Supreet Kaur, UC Berkeley
2023 **Graduate Student Researcher**, for Asst. Prof. Ellen Bruno, UC Berkeley
2021 **Research Assistant**, For Prof. Giacomo De Giorgi and Prof. Salvatore Di Falco, University of Geneva

Other Professional Experiences

2024 **Consultant - Research Assistant**, The World Bank
2020-2021 **Lead for Monitoring and Evaluation**, Centre Ecologique Albert Schweitzer, Switzerland
2019-2020 **Associate, Economic Security Unit**, International Committee of the Red Cross

Awards, Fellowships, & Grants

2026	**Research Grant**, Giannini Foundation for Agricultural Economics	*$34,736.75*
	Research Grant, Weiss Fund for Research in Development Economics	*$14,430.00*
	Merit Grant, Swiss Benevolent Society of San Francisco	*$5,000*
2025	**Research Grant**, Giannini Foundation for Agricultural Economics	*$25,000*
	Student Opportunity Fund, UC Berkeley Student Union	*$1000*
2024	**Development Economics Challenge**, Center for Effective Global Action	*$5,500*
	Sacheti Family Grant, UC Berkeley Agricultural and Resource Economics Department	*$3,000*
2023-2022	**Travel Grant**, UC Berkeley Agricutlural and Resource Economics Department (2x	*$3,00*
2019	**Best Masters Dissertation Award**, Economics Department, University of Geneva	*CHF 1,000*
2016	**Scholarship**, Fondation Barbour	*CHF 10,000*

Presentations

2026 **North East Universities Development Consortium annual conference**, Ithaca, New York
Development Economics Seminar, University of California, Berkeley
Agricultural and Resource Economics Deparmental Seminar, University of California, Berkeley
2026-2024 **Development Economics Lunch**, University of California, Berkeley *5x*
Development Workshop, University of California, Berkeley *5x*
2024 **Giannini Foundation of Agricultural and Resource Economics Student Conference (GARESC)**, Berkeley, California
Poster: Africa Evidence Summit, Dar Es Salaam, Tanzania,

Refereeing

Journal of Development Economics

Service & Mentoring

2025 **UC Berkeley ARE PhD Admissions Committee**, Committee Member
2024 **CEGA African Visiting Fellow Program**, Peer PhD Partner for Dr. Isaac Doku, Lecturer at the University of Education, Winneba, Ghana
Undergraduate Honor Thesis Mentor, Lakshmi Gopinathan, Undergraduate Student, University of California, Berkeley

Languages

French (native), English (fluent), Italian (fluent), Spanish (intermediate), German (elementary)